

Second Hong Kong Linguistics Olympiad
14 June 2020
Individual Contest Solutions

Problem 1 (25 points). Ainu

(a)

- 19. *You (sg) have showed them.*
- 20. *We were seeing ourselves.*
- 21. *He was donating you (sg). / They were donating you (sg). / You (sg) were donating him.*
- 22. *He has listened to them a lot. / They have listened to them a lot.*

(b)

- 23. *eci nupa wa oka*
- 24. *e yaynuruy wa an*
- 25. *ci koretекре wa an*
- 26. *ipepa as wa isam*
- 27. *inkarruypa wa oka*
- 28. *an nukartekpa wa isam*

Explanations:

1. Time / Aspect

- a. present perfect (has/have V3) – **wa isam**
- b. past continuous (was/were + Ving):
 - i. **wa an** – if the verb is considered *singular**.
 - ii. **wa oka** – if the verb is considered *plural**.

*In Ainu the plurality of the verb is given by the subject for intransitive verbs and by the object for the transitive verbs.

2. Person markers

Person	Subject (Intransitive)	Subject (Transitive)	Object
1 sg.	-an	an-	en-
2 sg.	e-	e-	e-
3 sg.	0	0	0
1 pl.	-as	ci-	un-
2 pl.	eci-	eci-	eci-
3 pl.	0	0	0

The dash before or after the particle indicates the position with respect to the verb (before or after). In the case of transitive verbs, if both the subject and the object particles are before verb, they merge together with the subject being first and the object after.

3. **Plurality marker** (as defined above): The suffix **-pa** attached to the verb.

4. **Verb-modifying affixes:**

- a. **yay-** : reflexive marker (note that in Ainu, *listening to oneself* = *thinking*)
- b. **-ruy** : verb intensifier (can be translated by *a lot*, but it also bears a semantic role modifying the verb (*eat-devour*, *see-stare* etc.)
- c. **-tek** : verb diminisher (the opposite of **-ruy** – *eat-taste*, *see-glance* etc.)
- d. **-(r)e** : causative marker (*eat* → *make someone eat* = *feed*, *see* → *make someone see* = *show*, *listen* = *make someone listen* → *tell*). If the verb root ends in **-r**, the suffix becomes **-e**.

5. **Verb roots:** Each verb has two different roots depending on transitivity:

Translation	Intransitive root	Transitive root
to eat	ipe	e
to see	inkar	nukar
to listen	inu	nu
to have	kor	-
to give	-	kore**

Even though for solving this problem **kore (give) can be taken as a separate root, it is actually the causative of **kor** (have → to make someone have = give).